It was a tough spot to be in. The problem was, I had already announced that I wanted to retire. But people I trusted were of the opinion that I needed to give league cricket and T20s another shot.

Meanwhile, at the PCB, there was a reshuffle in the works. Inzi bhai was the new chief selector. There was a new captain – the hard-working Sarfaraz Ahmed – in place. The media brought out its fangs, ripping into the old guard and gunning for new players. There was a whole new outlook which was being introduced in the team. Would I fit in? Tough question. But God bless Inzi bhai for giving me the option of doing whatever I wanted. He told me, 'We will do whatever works for you. You're in the driver's seat. You decide.'

To hear this from a selector was really a big deal. I've played most of my cricket under Inzi bhai. He's one heck of a cricketer. He's almost always kept his cool (that walk-off in England was not one of those moments). And he's only gotten wiser over the years.

That's where we came up with a great solution to what was brewing into a controversy around my retirement: I would play a farewell T20 match against the West Indies in the UAE.

The reasoning was simple. Inzi and I were both in agreement that Pakistani cricket, while great in tradition, lacked the ability to honour its best. Farewells are non-events. Players come. Players play. And then they either wither away or are kicked out unceremoniously (usually it's the latter). Unfortunately, that's the Pakistani nature of send-offs. And not just in cricket.

Inzi bhai and I also agreed that instead of an inglorious exit, why couldn't we start a new tradition? That's when he took the idea of a farewell match to the PCB. The chairman, Shehryar Khan sahib, was hospitalized at the time, so Inzi bhai took it to the COO, Subhan Ahmad. And, of course, Subhan Ahmad being Subhan Ahmad, took it to the press.

I was really disturbed by this development. All I'd wanted was to set a new precedent – a new tradition of honouring our sportsmen. In other countries, when a cricketer retires, prime ministers come and see off a player for his final farewell game. What's the big deal, I thought, if there was a ceremony or something to send me off?

The issue, really, was Najam Sethi. The new co-chairman – that's what his position essentially was – felt that he wasn't looped into this conversation. (This was the internal narrative of the PCB.) Thus, the matter was needlessly politicized. Instead, the story that began doing the rounds was that I was gunning for a custom-made farewell match especially designed for me to be featured in. Naturally, it made the wrong impression on the media, who obviously jumped on it.

You see, with Najam Sethi sahib it's rather clear. At the time, the PCB was in a particularly bizarre stage of its rather bizarre history: it had two chairpersons. Najam Sethi sahib may have been president of the board at the time but the decision-making in such matters was more of a 50:50 thing between him and Shehryar Khan. That's the way most Pakistani organizations are managed – or mismanaged, if you prefer. We divide and get conquered.

As for Sethi, well, I don't have any problems with the man, despite his political connections with – and appointment by – the Nawaz Sharif regime. Also, credit should be given where it's due. He has done a great job of growing the PSL and getting the zing in cricket back to Pakistan. The PSL is here to stay. At a time when the project was at a standstill, when it had no takers, he made things happen. Good for him and good for cricket.

But ego is a dangerous thing. And this is why I must recall what he did to me in my last days in the Pakistan team.